

# What Makes Someone **Return** Empty Packaging?

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A look at the consumer psychology  
behind a **Deposit Refund Scheme**  
**[DRS]**.



A Deposit Refund Scheme,  
through a **nominal refundable deposit**,  
gives DRS-eligible packaging a  
**value that remains** even after  
the product has been consumed.



**Its journey does not necessarily  
have to **end after consumption**.**



But even if that person  
chooses not to return it,  
**the value still remains.**

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**Someone else may  
pick it up & **return it**  
and claim the **refund value**  
attached to the empty packaging.**



**And the packaging can still find its way back  
into the recycling ecosystem.**





## That is where the behaviour behind DRS becomes **interesting**.

The value attached to packaging  
can create repeated moments  
of participation.



**One person  
returns it.**



**Then another.**



**And over time,  
returning becomes a  
more familiar part of  
what happens after  
consumption.**



# Lasting behavioural change isn't created by **information alone.**

It is supported by systems that give people a  
**clear way to act** and a reason to do it again.



**NOTICE**



**ACT**



**REPEAT**



**That is how individual actions can begin  
to become everyday habits.**